Skill 12

Separate Correlation and Causation

Cause or Coincidence?

160 Items	**1-5** Levels	**Explain why a cause claim is not proven yet.** Objective

Essential question. Has the argument shown that one thing caused another?

This PDF is designed for classroom use. It gives teachers a rigorous introduction to the skill, a repeatable solving routine, likely student confusions, a worked example, and the full XiXteen item set with choice-level feedback.

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Skill 12

Separate Correlation and Causation

Cause or Coincidence?

Explain why a cause claim is not proven yet. Objective	**160** Items	**Levels 1-5** Difficulty bands

Essential question	Has the argument shown that one thing caused another?
Why it matters	Cause claims are powerful because they suggest action. They also require discipline: timing, correlation, or improvement after a plan is not enough by itself.
Conceptual core	Causal claims are attractive because they suggest a lever for action. Students should learn that timing and correlation are clues, not proof. A responsible causal judgment asks about comparison groups, other changes, selection effects, reverse direction, and plausible mechanisms. This skill slows the leap from after this to because of this.
Student method	Look for another change that happened at the same time, a missing comparison group, reverse direction, selection effects, or a reason the result might have changed anyway.
Analogy	Causation is a courtroom claim. A suspect being near the scene matters, but it is not a conviction without ruling out other explanations.
Assessment focus	A good answer explains why the cause is not yet proven or identifies evidence that would better test the causal link.

Teaching Sequence

1. Check whether the alleged cause happened before the effect.

2. Ask what else changed at the same time.

3. Look for a comparison group or baseline trend.

4. Consider whether the effect could have influenced the supposed cause.

Common Confusions To Watch For

1. Students may assume that improvement after a plan proves the plan caused it.

2. Students may treat correlation as useless rather than as a clue that needs testing.

3. Students may ignore selection effects when people choose into a program.

Teacher Prompts

1. What would we need to compare?

2. What else could have changed?

3. Could the cause and effect be reversed or both caused by a third factor?

Worked Example

Scenario	Reported thefts drop after brighter streetlights are installed, but the city also increases evening patrols that month.
Teacher think-aloud	The drop is compatible with the lights helping, but patrols are a rival cause. A better design would compare similar streets with and without the lighting change while tracking patrol changes.
Student takeaway	A causal claim gets stronger when rival causes are ruled out.

Guided Classroom Exercise

Invented case. Use only the facts below; write on paper. Try the steps and check your work before reading the model answer. Different wording can be equally adequate.

Situation. Reported thefts on a street fall from 50 in September to 35 in October. Brighter lights are installed at the start of October, and extra evening patrols begin that same day. The mayor says the lights caused the drop.

What To Do

1. State the observed change separately from the mayor's causal explanation.

2. Name the other change that could explain some or all of the drop.

3. Propose a comparison that would help separate the effects: describe which streets to compare and which other condition should be kept similar. Do not claim your proposed comparison has already been done.

Check before reading the answer. Does the comparison vary lighting without also giving only the newly lit streets extra patrols?

Model Answer

The observation is that reports fell from 50 to 35 after two changes. Extra patrols are a rival explanation. Compare similar streets over the same period, some receiving brighter lights and others retaining existing lights, while keeping patrol levels comparable; random assignment of lighting would make the test stronger where feasible.

Why it is adequate. It identifies the simultaneous change and proposes evidence that could distinguish explanations instead of treating 'after' as 'because of'.

Item Bank

Items are grouped by level. For each item, read the prompt, predict the answer, choose, and then use the feedback and process commentary to examine the reasoning path.

Level 1

Level 1 establishes the clean version of the skill: the cue is direct, the distractors are visible, and the main task is to learn the contrast.

causation-001 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The city council tried a plan to extend evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, transportation, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-002 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried a plan to require phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-003 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The hospital tried a plan to send medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-004 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The company tried a plan to test a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-005 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The grocery chain tried a plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, retail, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-006 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried a plan to waive late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public services, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-007 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The platform tried a plan to require two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-008 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried a plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-009 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The university tried a plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-010 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The restaurant group tried a plan to show calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nutrition, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-011 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The bank tried a plan to send overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, finance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-012 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The park service tried a plan to use timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-013 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The museum tried a plan to offer free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, culture, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-014 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The sports league tried a plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, sports, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-015 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The nonprofit tried a plan to send donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nonprofit, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-016 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The warehouse tried a plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-017 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried a plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-018 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The app maker tried a plan to make new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-019 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The clinic tried a plan to reserve same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-020 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried a plan to board passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, travel, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-021 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The landlord tried a plan to launch an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, housing, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-022 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The cafeteria tried a plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, food, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-023 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The call center tried a plan to give support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, customer support, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-024 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The water utility tried a plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, utilities, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-025 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The police department tried a plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, governance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-026 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The election office tried a plan to offer online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, election administration, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-027 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The tutoring app tried a plan to send spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, learning, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-028 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The gym tried a plan to offer a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The orientation mats are black. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, fitness, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-029 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The insurer tried a plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, insurance, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-030 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried a plan to place corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, media, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-031 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried a plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, local commerce, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-032 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The hotel tried a plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, hospitality, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

Level 2

Level 2 keeps the same skill but adds more realistic wording and more tempting distractors.

causation-033 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried a plan to extend evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, transportation, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-034 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried a plan to require phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-035 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried a plan to send medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-036 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried a plan to test a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-037 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried a plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, retail, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-038 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried a plan to waive late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public services, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-039 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried a plan to require two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-040 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried a plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public safety, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-041 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The university tried a plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-042 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The restaurant group tried a plan to show calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nutrition, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-043 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried a plan to send overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, finance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-044 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The park service tried a plan to use timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-045 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The museum tried a plan to offer free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, culture, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-046 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The sports league tried a plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, sports, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-047 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The nonprofit tried a plan to send donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nonprofit, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-048 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The warehouse tried a plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace safety, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-049 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried a plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-050 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The app maker tried a plan to make new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-051 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried a plan to reserve same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-052 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried a plan to board passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, travel, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-053 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The landlord tried a plan to launch an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, housing, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-054 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The cafeteria tried a plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, food, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-055 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The call center tried a plan to give support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, customer support, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-056 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The water utility tried a plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, utilities, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-057 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The police department tried a plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, governance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-058 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The election office tried a plan to offer online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, election administration, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-059 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The tutoring app tried a plan to send spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, learning, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-060 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The gym tried a plan to offer a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The orientation mats are black. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, fitness, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-061 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The insurer tried a plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, insurance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-062 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The newsroom tried a plan to place corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, media, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-063 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried a plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, local commerce, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-064 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried a plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, hospitality, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

Level 3

Level 3 asks for steadier discrimination: the right answer is still objective, but the wrong answers often sound plausible.

causation-065 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The city council tried a plan to extend evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, transportation, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-066 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried a plan to require phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-067 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The hospital tried a plan to send medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-068 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The company tried a plan to test a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-069 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The grocery chain tried a plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, retail, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-070 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried a plan to waive late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public services, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-071 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The platform tried a plan to require two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-072 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried a plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-073 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The university tried a plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-074 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The restaurant group tried a plan to show calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nutrition, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-075 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The bank tried a plan to send overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, finance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-076 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The park service tried a plan to use timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-077 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The museum tried a plan to offer free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, culture, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-078 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The sports league tried a plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, sports, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-079 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The nonprofit tried a plan to send donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nonprofit, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-080 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The warehouse tried a plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-081 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried a plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-082 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The app maker tried a plan to make new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-083 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The clinic tried a plan to reserve same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-084 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried a plan to board passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, travel, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-085 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The landlord tried a plan to launch an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, housing, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-086 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The cafeteria tried a plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, food, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-087 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The call center tried a plan to give support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, customer support, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-088 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The water utility tried a plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, utilities, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-089 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried a plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, governance, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-090 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The election office tried a plan to offer online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, election administration, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-091 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The tutoring app tried a plan to send spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, learning, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-092 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The gym tried a plan to offer a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, fitness, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-093 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The insurer tried a plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, insurance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-094 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The newsroom tried a plan to place corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, media, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-095 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried a plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, local commerce, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-096 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The hotel tried a plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, hospitality, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

Level 4

Level 4 asks learners to hold more context in mind while applying the same method.

causation-097 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The city council tried a plan to extend evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, transportation, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-098 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried a plan to require phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-099 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried a plan to send medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-100 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The company tried a plan to test a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-101 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The grocery chain tried a plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, retail, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-102 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried a plan to waive late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public services, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-103 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried a plan to require two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-104 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried a plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-105 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The university tried a plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-106 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The restaurant group tried a plan to show calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nutrition, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-107 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried a plan to send overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, finance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-108 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The park service tried a plan to use timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-109 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The museum tried a plan to offer free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, culture, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-110 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The sports league tried a plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, sports, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-111 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The nonprofit tried a plan to send donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nonprofit, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-112 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The warehouse tried a plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace safety, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-113 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried a plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-114 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The app maker tried a plan to make new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-115 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried a plan to reserve same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-116 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The airline tried a plan to board passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, travel, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-117 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The landlord tried a plan to launch an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, housing, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-118 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried a plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, food, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-119 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The call center tried a plan to give support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, customer support, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-120 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried a plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, utilities, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-121 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The police department tried a plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, governance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-122 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried a plan to offer online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, election administration, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-123 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The tutoring app tried a plan to send spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, learning, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-124 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried a plan to offer a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, fitness, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-125 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The insurer tried a plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, insurance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-126 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried a plan to place corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, media, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-127 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried a plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, local commerce, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-128 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The hotel tried a plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, hospitality, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

Level 5

Level 5 is for fluency: the learner should now name the thinking move and explain the elimination path.

causation-129 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The city council tried a plan to extend evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, transportation, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-130 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried a plan to require phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-131 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The hospital tried a plan to send medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-132 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The company tried a plan to test a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-133 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The grocery chain tried a plan to add larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, retail, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-134 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried a plan to waive late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public services, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-135 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The platform tried a plan to require two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-136 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried a plan to add brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, public safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-137 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The university tried a plan to expand peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, education, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-138 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The restaurant group tried a plan to show calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nutrition, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-139 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The bank tried a plan to send overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, finance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-140 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The park service tried a plan to use timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-141 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The museum tried a plan to offer free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, culture, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-142 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The sports league tried a plan to add mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, sports, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-143 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The nonprofit tried a plan to send donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, nonprofit, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-144 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The warehouse tried a plan to offer monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, workplace safety, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-145 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried a plan to place compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, environment, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-146 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The app maker tried a plan to make new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-147 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The clinic tried a plan to reserve same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-148 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The airline tried a plan to board passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, travel, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-149 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The landlord tried a plan to launch an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, housing, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-150 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried a plan to move fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, food, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-151 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The call center tried a plan to give support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, customer support, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-152 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried a plan to send automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, utilities, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-153 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried a plan to send body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Taylor's claim is not proved yet?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is A because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, governance, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-154 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried a plan to offer online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Morgan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is B because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, election administration, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

causation-155 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The tutoring app tried a plan to send spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Casey's claim is not proved yet?

A. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**B.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, learning, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

causation-156 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried a plan to offer a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Jordan's claim is not proved yet?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, fitness, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-157 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The insurer tried a plan to send weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Riley's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, insurance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

causation-158 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The newsroom tried a plan to place corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Maya's claim is not proved yet?

A. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**D.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, media, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-159 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried a plan to require clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Sam's claim is not proved yet?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice	**D.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is D because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, local commerce, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

causation-160 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The hotel tried a plan to send quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which fact would show why Avery's claim is not proved yet?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail describes the setting but does not identify a competing cause. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes the change but does not identify a competing cause. choice
C. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan began before the result changed, which shows timing but does not rule out other causes during that period or separate the plan from them. choice

Core explanation. To prove cause, you need to rule out other likely causes or compare similar groups.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, ask what else changed or what comparison is missing. The correct choice is C because it blocks the leap from observed change to proven cause.

Tags: causation, confounder, hospitality, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A visible detail may describe the situation, but it does not rule out other causes.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage can describe a change, but it does not by itself show what caused the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This fact gives a live alternative cause, so the observed change cannot yet be credited to the plan alone.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing can be relevant, but timing alone does not prove the plan caused the result.